

HOUSE OF ROSE



The Waxing Guide

*Everything You Need to Know — From Science to Technique Body Zones ·
Application Direction · Aftercare · Products*

A COMPLETE GUIDE FOR CLIENTS, PRACTITIONERS & NEW ESTHETICIANS

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CONTENTS

What's Inside

CHAPTER ONE	4
The Science of Waxing — Hair Growth, Why Waxing Wins	
CHAPTER TWO	6
Wax Types & When to Use Them — Soft, Hard, Sugar	
CHAPTER THREE	9
Body Zone Map — Services, Directions & Pain Guide	
CHAPTER FOUR	14
Application Technique — Direction by Zone	
CHAPTER FIVE	17
Pre-Service Preparation	
CHAPTER SIX	19
The Appointment — Step by Step	
CHAPTER SEVEN	21
Aftercare — The 48-Hour Rule	
CHAPTER EIGHT	23
Ingrown Hairs — Prevention & Treatment	
CHAPTER NINE	25
After-Products — The Full Home Routine	
CHAPTER TEN	28
Sensitive Skin Protocol	
CHAPTER ELEVEN	30
Waxing Timeline — When to Rebook	
CHAPTER TWELVE	32
Industry Intel — What the Best Chains Do	
APPENDIX	34

[Quick Reference Charts](#) · [Medications](#) · [FAQ](#)

"Smooth skin is not a luxury. It is a ritual."

A WORD FROM HOUSE OF ROSE

Whether you are stepping into our suite for the first time or looking to refine everything you know about waxing, this guide was written for you. At House of Rose, education is the foundation of every great result. Waxing is not simply hair removal — it is a precision service that, done correctly, leaves skin softer, smoother, and more luminous with every appointment.

Inside these pages you will find the biology of hair growth, professional technique direction charts sourced from industry-leading training curricula, zone-by-zone application guides, complete aftercare science, and an honest breakdown of what the industry's largest chains do — so you can understand the standard and what exceeds it.

Use this as your reference, your ritual guide, and your roadmap to the smoothest skin of your life.

— *House of Rose Aesthetics*

CHAPTER ONE

The Science of Waxing

The Hair Growth Cycle

Human hair follows a continuous three-phase cycle. Understanding it is the most important concept in professional waxing — it governs your appointment timing, results quality, and how your skin changes over months of consistent service.

Phase	Name	Duration	Description
1	Anagen — Growth	2–6 weeks	Hair grows actively from the follicle. Best phase for waxing — root is anchored.
2	Catagen — Transition	2–3 weeks	Growth slows. Follicle begins to shrink. Hair loosens slightly.
3	Telogen — Rest	3–4 months	Hair rests and eventually sheds. New cycle begins beneath.

♦ WHY CONSISTENCY MATTERS

Only 20–30% of your hair is in active growth at any time. This is why the first 2–3 waxing appointments may show uneven regrowth — the cycles are out of sync. Consistent appointments every 3–5 weeks gradually synchronize your hair cycle, producing progressively sparser, finer regrowth within 3–4 months.

Waxing vs. Shaving — The Real Difference

Shaving cuts hair at the skin surface, leaving a blunt, coarse tip that feels stubbly in 24–48 hours. Waxing removes the entire hair from the root — regrowth comes in with a natural tapered tip, softer to the touch, visually finer. With repeated waxing the follicle wall weakens, producing progressively thinner hair and, in some areas, permanent reduction over time.

Factor	Waxing	Shaving
Smoothness duration	3–6 weeks	1–3 days
Regrowth texture	Soft, tapered	Blunt, coarse

Long-term reduction	Yes, with consistency	No
Exfoliation benefit	Yes — removes dead cells	Minimal
Risk of cuts	None	Yes
Ingrown hair risk	Low (with aftercare)	High

CHAPTER TWO

Wax Types & When to Use Them

Choosing the right wax is as important as technique. Each formulation was designed for specific hair types, body zones, and skin conditions. At House of Rose, we select professional-grade wax based on skin sensitivity, hair coarseness, and the treatment area.

Soft Wax (Strip Wax)

Best for: Large body areas — legs, arms, back, chest, stomach

Min. length: ¼ inch — about 2–3 weeks from a shave

Skin type: Normal–oily skin

Applied in a thin layer, removed with a muslin or non-woven strip. Adheres to both hair and skin surface — never apply to the same area twice. Fast and economical for large zones.

Hard Wax (No-Strip Wax)

Best for: Sensitive zones — bikini, Brazilian, underarms, face

Min. length: ¼ inch minimum, ½ inch ideal

Skin type: All types, especially sensitive

Applied warm and thickly, allowed to harden, then removed without a strip. Shrink-wraps around the hair shaft without gripping the skin. Can be applied over the same area twice for clean results. Our standard for all Brazilian, bikini, and facial services.

Sugar Wax (Sugaring)

Best for: Full body — especially sensitive or reactive skin

Min. length: ■ inch — grabs shorter hair than wax

Skin type: Sensitive, reactive, folliculitis-prone

Sugar, lemon, and water — completely natural. Applied against hair growth, removed in the direction of growth, which reduces breakage and follicle trauma. Rinses off with water.

Chocolate Wax

Best for: Face and body — dry or mature skin

Min. length: ¼ inch

Skin type: Dry, mature

Cocoa and glycerin-rich formula with soothing antioxidants. Lower temperature, gentler adhesion, excellent for clients whose skin reacts to standard wax resin.

◆ HOUSE OF ROSE STANDARD

At House of Rose, we use hard wax exclusively for all Brazilian, bikini, and facial waxing services — zero strip contact on your most sensitive skin. This is the same approach that separates professional boutique waxing from chain-model services.

CHAPTER THREE

Body Zone Map

Every area of the body responds differently to waxing. Below is a zone-by-zone guide covering wax type, minimum hair length, regrowth timeline, pain expectation, and clinical notes for each service area.

Full Legs

Wax: Soft wax

Min. Length: ¼ inch

Regrowth: 4–6 weeks

Pain: Low

The most popular large-area service. Includes shins, calves, thighs, and behind the knee. Hair grows at different rates on upper vs. lower leg — first sessions may feel uneven; consistency corrects this within 2–3 cycles.

Underarms

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ¼–½ inch

Regrowth: 3–4 weeks

Pain: Moderate–High

One of the fastest sessions (5–10 min) but among the most sensitive due to lymph nodes and thin skin. Avoid deodorant 24 hours before. First session most intense; subsequent visits are dramatically more comfortable as the follicle weakens.

Eyebrows

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ■ inch

Regrowth: 3–4 weeks

Pain: Low

Precision shaping using a thin spatula. We map the arch to facial structure before removing a single hair. No guesswork — only intentional, face-framing results.

Upper Lip

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ■ inch

Regrowth: 3–4 weeks

Pain: Moderate

Fast service (under 5 min). Hair will not grow back darker or thicker — a persistent myth. Hair appears finer over time with consistent waxing.

Chin & Jawline

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ■–¼ inch

Regrowth: 3–5 weeks

Pain: Low–Moderate

Hormonal hair on the chin is typically coarser; hard wax provides the cleanest removal. Clients with PCOS or on hormonal medications may need 3-week intervals initially.

Full Face

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ■ inch

Regrowth: 3–4 weeks

Pain: Low–Moderate

Includes hairline, brows, nose, upper lip, lower lip, chin, neck, cheeks, and sideburns — 9 service zones. Priced as a package service.

Bikini Line

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ¼ inch

Regrowth: 4–5 weeks

Pain: Moderate

Cleans up the bikini perimeter — panty line, extended, or modified (top and sides). Great entry point for first-time bikini wax clients.

Bikini Full

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ¼–½ inch

Regrowth: 4–5 weeks

Pain: Moderate–High

Removes hair from the front with client's choice of shape — landing strip, triangle, or bare. Everything between the legs stays.

Brazilian

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: ¼–½ inch

Regrowth: 4–6 weeks

Pain: High (first visit)

Full Brazilian removes all hair from pubic area, labia, and between the cheeks. First-time clients are typically surprised by how fast it goes (20–30 min). Communication during your service is always welcomed.

Back (Men)

Wax: Soft wax

Min. Length: ¼–½ inch

Regrowth: 5–6 weeks

Pain: Low–Moderate

Full back and shoulders waxed with soft strip wax for speed across large muscle surface. Coarse or dense hair may require two passes. Results last longest of any area due to slower torso growth cycle.

Chest (Men)

Wax: Soft wax

Min. Length: ¼ inch

Regrowth: 4–5 weeks

Pain: Low–Moderate

Chest contour or full removal. Common with athletes and bodybuilders. Sternum hair is typically most coarse.

Full Arms

Wax: Soft wax

Min. Length: ¼ inch

Regrowth: 4–6 weeks

Pain: Very Low

Wrist to shoulder. Arm hair is typically fine, making this one of the least painful services with exceptionally long-lasting results.

Stomach

Wax: Soft wax

Min. Length: ¼ inch

Regrowth: 4–5 weeks

Pain: Low

Midline strip or full stomach. Quick, low-discomfort service. Common for men and for women with hormonally-influenced abdominal hair.

Nose

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: Visible length

Regrowth: 4–6 weeks

Pain: Low

Hard wax applied to nostril interior using a small applicator. One of the most satisfying quick add-on services.

Ears

Wax: Hard wax

Min. Length: Visible length

Regrowth: 4–6 weeks

Pain: Very Low

Removes ear canal and outer ear hair. Common male add-on.

Feet & Toes

Wax: Soft wax

Min. Length: ■ inch

Regrowth: 6–8 weeks

Pain: Very Low

Often added to leg services. Hair grows very slowly here — results are extremely long-lasting.

CHAPTER FOUR

Application Technique — Direction by Zone

Correct wax application direction is the single most important technical variable in professional waxing. Get it wrong and you break hair at the surface instead of removing it from the root — causing ingrowns, patchy results, and unnecessary skin trauma. The universal rule is simple: apply with the hair, remove against it. What changes zone by zone is the specific direction hair actually grows in each area.

◆ THE UNIVERSAL RULE

The universal rule: wax applied in the direction of hair growth fully encapsulates the follicle. Removed swiftly against the hair direction, it extracts from the root. Applying immediate pressure after each pull calms nerve endings before they register the sting. This is non-negotiable for clean results.

Hard Wax Application (*Bikini · Brazilian · Underarms · Face*)

Hard wax has a unique application technique that differs from strip wax and is often counterintuitive for new practitioners:

1	Apply	Apply the wax AGAINST the direction of hair growth with firm pressure. This initial pass against-grain helps the wax grip the base of the hair shaft at the follicle opening.
2	Spread	Immediately spread it back IN the direction of hair growth to approximately the thickness of a banana skin — roughly 2–3mm. This layer thickness is critical: too thin and the wax snaps on removal; too thick and it doesn't flex cleanly.
3	Form the lip	Leave a thicker 'lip' or tab at the end of the strip opposite the direction you'll pull — this is what you grip for removal. No loose end = no clean pull.
4	Test	Allow the wax to set until it is firm but still slightly flexible. Test by pressing the edge — if it feels leathery and lifts cleanly, it's ready.

5**Remove**

Remove with a motion described as 'a plane taking off' — bend your wrist around the contour of the body, pulling parallel to the skin, never upward. Upward pulls bruise and lift skin.

6**Press**

Apply immediate firm pressure with your palm or fingers to the area just pulled. This overrides the pain signal before the nerves can transmit it.

Soft Wax Application (Legs · Arms · Back · Chest · Stomach)

Soft (strip) wax follows a simpler directional protocol but requires precise 45-degree spatula angle and proper strip technique:

1**Angle the spatula**

Hold the spatula at 45 degrees to the skin. Apply a thin, even layer in the direction of hair growth — allow wax to slide off the edge of the spatula as it moves across. Thin is critical: thick application wastes product and increases skin adhesion.

2**Place the strip**

Immediately press the muslin or non-woven strip over the wax. Leave a wax-free tab at the far end of the strip for gripping. Rub the strip firmly 2–3 times in the direction of hair growth to bond it to the hair.

3**Anchor and pull**

Place your non-dominant hand firmly on the skin at the pulling end to hold skin taut. Grip the tab with your other hand. Pull swiftly, close and parallel to the skin, against the direction of hair growth. Never pull upward.

4**Press immediately**

Apply firm pressure the moment the strip clears the skin.

5**Never double-apply**

Soft wax can only be applied to the same area once — it will lift the top layer of skin on second application. If any hairs remain, use tweezers.

Direction Reference — Zone by Zone

Hair does not grow uniformly across the body. These are the actual directional maps used in professional esthetician training:

Zone	Hair Grows Toward	Apply Wax	Remove Strip/Wax	Notes
Bikini / Brazilian — front	Inward (inner thigh) & downward	With growth direction	Against — parallel to skin	Work in small 2–3 inch sections, top to inward
Underarms	Two directions: up & down	Each section separately, with growth	Against each section's direction	Arm raised overhead, elbow bent back to tighten skin
Legs — lower	Downward (toward ankle)	Down the leg with growth	Up the leg, against growth	Check — some have sideways growth on shins
Legs — upper thigh	Downward, sometimes sideways	Check direction before applying	Against confirmed growth direction	Inner thigh hair often grows inward
Arms	Typically downward (toward wrist) — varies	Check before applying	Against confirmed growth direction	Normal for arm hair to grow in more than one direction
Back / Shoulders	Downward toward lumbar	Down the back	Up the back, against growth	Upper back hair may grow outward toward shoulders
Upper lip	Downward from nose	Down, along lip line	Upward, against growth	Skin held taut at outer cheek edge with non-dominant hand
Chin	Downward	Down	Upward	Work in small sections — facial hair varies
Eyebrows	Various — check each section	With each section's growth	Against each section's growth	Map brow shape before any removal
Bikini line — outer	Downward toward inner thigh	Downward with growth	Upward, against growth	Client can help hold skin taut to reduce discomfort

CHAPTER FIVE

Pre-Service Preparation

How you prepare your skin in the 24–72 hours before your appointment directly impacts comfort, result quality, and recovery time.

72 Hours Before

- Exfoliate once — gentle scrub or dry brush to clear dead skin from follicle openings.
- Stop retinoids (Retin-A, tretinoin, retinol) on wax zones. These thin the skin and increase lifting risk.
- Avoid tanning or UV exposure to areas being waxed.
- Stay well hydrated — hydrated skin releases hair more cleanly.

24 Hours Before

- Do not shave. Hair must be at least ¼ inch (2–3 weeks of growth from a shave).
- Skip heavy lotions, oils, or self-tanner on wax zones — product residue prevents adhesion.
- Avoid chemical exfoliants (AHAs, BHAs) on the wax zone.
- For facial waxing: stop active acne treatments (benzoyl peroxide, salicylic acid) on the area.

Day of Appointment

- Shower and arrive with clean, product-free skin.
- Wear loose, comfortable clothing — especially important for Brazilian and bikini services.
- Skip deodorant if having underarms waxed.
- Take ibuprofen 30–45 minutes before if you are pain-sensitive. Do not take blood thinners.
- If menstruating: skin is more sensitive 3–5 days before and during your period. We'll work with extra care.

■ CAUTION

Do NOT wax if currently on isotretinoin (Accutane) or within 6 months of stopping — waxing will tear the skin. Additional contraindications: active sunburn, open wounds, broken skin, active psoriasis or eczema flares in the treatment zone. Always disclose all medications at your appointment.

Hair Length — The Most Common Mistake

Hair too short is the number one reason for incomplete waxing results. The wax cannot grip hair under ¼ inch.

Time Since Shaving	Approx. Length	Ready?
1 week	1/16 – 1/8 inch	No — too short
2 weeks	1/8 – 3/16 inch	Possibly — borderline
3 weeks	¼ inch	Yes — minimum
4–5 weeks	½ inch+	Ideal

CHAPTER SIX

The Appointment — Step by Step

Knowing what happens during your appointment eliminates anxiety and helps you communicate effectively with your esthetician. This is exactly what happens from arrival to exit.

1	Consultation & Intake	Medications, skin conditions, and waxing goals reviewed. First-time clients receive a full zone walkthrough.
2	Cleanse	Pre-wax cleanser removes all surface oils, dead cells, and product residue. Clean skin = clean adhesion.
3	Pre-Wax Oil	A thin barrier oil applied to sensitive zones. Creates microscopic protection between skin and wax — wax grips hair, not skin.
4	Wax Application	Applied in sections using a clean spatula, direction-correct per zone. Temperature checked — warm, never hot.
5	Removal	Strip wax: removed with muslin against growth, parallel to skin. Hard wax: removed without strip, wrist-bend motion. Immediate pressure applied post-pull.
6	Tweeze & Detail	Any stray hairs missed by wax — too short, flat-lying — removed with sterilized tweezers.
7	Post-Wax Treatment	Post-wax oil or serum applied to remove residue and calm the follicle. Azulene, chamomile, or CBD-based formulas reduce redness and close the follicle opening.
8	Aftercare Briefing	48-hour rules reviewed, home product recommendations given, next appointment booked.

◆ HYGIENE NON-NEGOTIABLES

Hygiene standard every visit: new gloves per guest, wax sticks never double-dipped, all tools soaked in disinfectant or disposed of, suite bed sanitized with disinfectant wipes and fresh paper pulled per guest. This is non-negotiable — not optional.

CHAPTER SEVEN

Aftercare — The 48-Hour Rule

The follicle is open and the skin is temporarily sensitized immediately after waxing. What you do in the next 48 hours determines healing speed, result duration, and comfort of your next visit.

The Avoid List — 48 Hours Post-Wax

× Hot showers, baths, saunas	Heat further opens the follicle, increasing redness and bacterial risk.
× Swimming pools & hot tubs	Chlorine and bacteria are highly irritating to freshly waxed, open follicles.
× Exercise & heavy sweating	Sweat in open follicles triggers folliculitis — infected hair bumps.
× Sun exposure & tanning beds	Sensitized skin burns and pigments more easily. SPF is essential outdoors.
× Tight clothing over waxed areas	Friction against open follicles causes irritation. Loose breathable fabrics only.
× Makeup on facial wax zones	Cosmetic ingredients clog recently opened follicles on lips and brows.
× Scented or alcohol-based products	These inflame the skin barrier before it heals.
× Sexual activity (Brazilian / bikini)	Friction and bacteria risk in the first 24–48 hours.
× Scratching the area	Nails introduce bacteria. Apply cool compress if itchy.
× Shaving between waxes	Disrupts the hair cycle sync and causes itching and ingrowns.

What You Should Do

- Apply post-wax soothing oil or serum the same day and the following morning.
- Keep skin cool and dry — room temperature is ideal.

- Wear loose cotton clothing over treated areas.
- Begin gentle exfoliation 3 days after your appointment, 2–3 times per week.
- Apply ingrown hair serum (glycolic or salicylic acid-based) starting 48 hours post-wax if prone to ingrowns.
- Moisturize daily with a non-comedogenic body lotion once skin has settled (48 hours+).
- Book your next appointment before leaving the suite — consistency is everything.

CHAPTER EIGHT

Ingrown Hairs — Prevention & Treatment

An ingrown hair occurs when a hair curls back into the skin instead of growing upward through the follicle opening. Most common in coarse or curly hair types and high-friction zones — bikini line, underarms, inner thigh. Almost entirely preventable.

Prevention Protocol

Timing	Action
Days 1–2	No exfoliation. Let the skin settle and follicles close.
Day 3+	Begin dry brushing or gentle scrub 2–3x per week in circular motion.
Daily	Apply ingrown hair serum (glycolic or salicylic acid-based) to prone areas.
Daily	Moisturize with a lightweight, non-comedogenic lotion to keep skin supple.
Always	Wear breathable fabrics over freshly waxed zones for 48 hours post-service.

If You Already Have an Ingrown

- Do not squeeze or dig. You will push the hair deeper and introduce bacteria.
- Apply a warm compress for 5–10 minutes to soften the skin above the hair.
- Use a 2% salicylic acid toner on the area to dissolve the skin cap over the follicle.
- If the hair tip is visible at the surface, a sterile lancet can gently lift it — then let it grow out naturally. Do not pull it out.
- If the area is red, swollen, or has a forming pustule: apply benzoyl peroxide. If unresolved in 3–5 days, see a dermatologist.

◆ TOP PICK FOR INGROWNS & DARK SPOTS

PFB Vanish + Chromabright: glycolic acid for exfoliation + kojic acid and niacinamide for post-inflammatory hyperpigmentation. Apply every other day starting 48 hours post-wax. The best single product for chronic ingrown and PIH clients.

CHAPTER NINE

After-Products — The Full Home Routine

Your home routine is what keeps results lasting longer, skin clearer, and each appointment more comfortable. The leading chains like European Wax Center have built entire retail lines around this — their EWC TREAT® products are the largest revenue driver per visit beyond the wax service itself.

Post-Wax Soothing Oil / Calming Serum

SAME DAY

- Removes residual wax without irritating sensitized skin.
- Delivers azulene, chamomile, or CBD extract to calm the follicle.
- Applied in-suite; reapply at home same evening.

Recommended: GiGi Azulene Oil · Lycon Post-Wax Oil · Satin Smooth Soothing Serum · EWC TREAT® Ingrown Hair Serum (\$40)

Ingrown Hair Serum

START 48 HRS POST-WAX

- Chemical exfoliant (salicylic, glycolic, or lactic acid) keeps the follicle clear.
- Prevents dead skin buildup over emerging hair.
- Use every other day — daily use can over-exfoliate.

Recommended: PFB Vanish · Tend Skin · EWC TREAT® Ingrown Hair Mist (\$30) · EWC Brightening Ingrown Hair Wipes (\$36)

Exfoliating Scrub

3 DAYS POST-WAX, 2–3X WEEKLY

- Physical exfoliation loosens the dead skin cap around follicle openings.
- Light circular pressure only — aggressive scrubbing creates micro-tears.
- Fine granules (sugar, pumice) — not nut shell fragments.

Recommended: Whish Flawless Body Polish · Completely Bare Bikini Bump Blaster · Tree Hut Sugar Scrub

Daily Moisturizer

DAILY (48 HRS+)

- Hydrated skin releases hair cleanly and is less prone to irritation.

- Non-comedogenic formulas only — heavy creams can block freshly opened follicles.
- EWC SLOW® Coconut Body Oil (\$16.50) and Aloe Body Lotion are their top retail movers.

Recommended: CeraVe Body Lotion · EWC SLOW® Coconut Body Oil · Kiehl's Creme de Corps

SPF (Face Wax Clients)

DAILY (48 HRS+)

- Freshly waxed facial skin is more susceptible to UV-triggered hyperpigmentation.
- SPF 30+ daily on any waxed facial zones.
- Mineral SPF (zinc oxide / titanium dioxide) is gentler than chemical filters.

Recommended: EltaMD UV Clear SPF 46 · Colorescience Sunforgettable · Supergoop Unseen SPF 40

Brightening / PIH Treatment

OPTIONAL — 48 HRS+

- Post-inflammatory hyperpigmentation (dark spots) from coarser hair or darker skin tones.
- Niacinamide, kojic acid, and vitamin C target melanin production in the follicle.
- Use at night — these can increase sun sensitivity.

Recommended: Good Molecules Niacinamide 12% · PFB Vanish + Chromabright · EWC Brightening Ingrown Hair Serum (\$40)

CHAPTER TEN

Sensitive Skin Protocol

Sensitive skin requires a modified approach, not avoidance. The vast majority of clients who identify as 'sensitive' can wax safely and comfortably with the right technique, wax selection, and product support.

Conditions That Qualify as Sensitive Skin

- Rosacea or easily flushed skin
- Eczema — outside of active flares
- Thin or mature skin that bruises easily
- Post-Accutane skin — 6+ months off medication minimum
- Keratosis pilaris (rough bumpy texture on arms/thighs)
- Hyperpigmentation or history of PIH from hair removal
- Psoriasis — outside of active flares
- Diabetes — slower healing, higher infection risk, extra aftercare applied

Our Modified Protocol

Patch Test	All new sensitive skin clients receive a small test wax 24 hours before a full service when possible.
Wax Selection	Low-temperature hard wax exclusively — gentler formula, no-strip application minimizes skin trauma.
Pre-Wax Barrier	Extra pre-wax oil applied to create a thicker protective layer between wax and skin.
Technique	Smaller sections, slightly thicker wax layers, slower controlled removal motion.
Post-Wax	Azulene or aloe-based cooling gel applied immediately. Cool compress provided if significant redness.
Home Care	Over-the-counter 1% hydrocortisone cream for first 24 hours if redness or itching persists.

■ CAUTION

Absolute contraindications for any wax service: active isotretinoin use, active sunburn, open wounds or skin infections, chemotherapy without physician clearance, active psoriasis or eczema flares in the treatment zone. When in doubt — reschedule. Your skin's safety is always the priority.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

Waxing Timeline — When to Rebook

Consistency is where waxing transforms from a one-time service into a long-term skin investment. Clients who commit to a regular schedule experience progressively sparser, finer regrowth, less discomfort over time, and dramatically smoother skin texture between appointments.

When to Book Your Next Appointment

Service	Book Again In	Notes
Full Legs	4–6 weeks	Hair grows slower on lower leg; upper thigh may need more frequent visits initially.
Underarms	3–4 weeks	Fast regrowth zone. Consistency syncs hair cycles within 3 visits.
Brazilian / Bikini	4–5 weeks	Most visible improvement over 3–4 regular visits as cycles align.
Brows	3–4 weeks	Maintains shape precision. Longer gaps require more removal per visit.
Face (Lip / Chin)	3–4 weeks	Facial follicles weaken faster than any other zone with consistency.
Back / Chest (Men)	5–6 weeks	Slowest-growing zone. Most cost-effective service per week of smoothness.

CHAPTER TWELVE

Industry Intel — What the Best Chains Do

Understanding the industry standard helps you recognize what a premium boutique experience adds. Here is what European Wax Center — the largest professional wax chain in the United States with 1,000+ locations — does across their client and employee operations, sourced from their public site and publicly indexed employee training materials.

EWC Service Pricing (National Starting Rates)

Service	Starting Price	Service	Starting Price
Bikini Line	\$39	Lips	\$12
Bikini Full	\$47	Chin	\$13
Brazilian	\$56	Cheeks / Neck / Sideburns	\$15
Lower Legs	\$42	Nose / Ears	\$16
Full Legs	\$75	Eyebrows	\$21
Half Arms	\$38	Full Face	\$59
Underarms	\$24	Full Back	\$63

EWC prices are national starting rates. Prices vary by location.

EWC's 4-Step Service Method

- 1. Cleanse:** Pre-wax cleanser removes makeup, oils, and lotions before every service.
- 2. Protect:** Pre-wax oil applied as a protective barrier — wax grips hair, not skin.
- 3. Wax:** Exclusive Comfort Wax® — hard, strip-less, adheres to hair not skin.
- 4. Rejuvenate:** EWC TREAT® Ingrown Hair Serum applied post-service to soothe and prevent ingrowns.

EWC Hygiene Standards (Employee Protocol)

- New gloves for every single service — replaced between waxes.
- Waxing sticks never double-dipped into the wax pot.
- All tools soaked in disinfectant or disposed of after each guest.
- Wax suite beds sanitized with disinfectant wipes after every guest — fresh paper pulled each time.
- All staff receive additional hygiene safety and sanitation training beyond state board requirements.
- Contactless check-in available at participating locations.

EWC Employee Training — Key Facts

- Wax Specialists receive 6 days of formal in-center training plus ongoing development.
- No training fees charged to employees.
- Four in-center roles: Guest Service Associate, Wax Specialist, Laser Hair Technician, Center Manager.
- Free School Partner eLearning module available to beauty school students — covers face and body waxing tips, maintaining wax, and proper techniques.
- The eLearning module is a pre-hire educational tool only; all formal training is managed in-center.
- Licensing requirements vary by state — EWC provides all on-the-job training and materials after hire.

APPENDIX

Quick Reference Charts

Medications That Affect Waxing

Medication	Effect	Action
Isotretinoin (Accutane)	Severely thins skin — wax will lift and tear	Do NOT wax — wait 6 months after stopping
Topical retinoids (Retin-A, tretinoin)	Thins and sensitizes skin locally	Stop use 5 days pre-wax on wax zones
Blood thinners (warfarin, aspirin)	Increases bruising and bleeding risk	Consult physician before waxing
Corticosteroids (prednisone, topical hydrocortisone)	Thins skin with prolonged use	Disclose; patch test recommended
Hormonal medications (birth control, HRT)	May affect hair growth patterns	No contraindication — disclose for records
Antibiotics (doxycycline, tetracyclines)	Increases sun sensitivity of skin	SPF diligently post-wax
Diabetes medications	Slower healing, higher infection risk	Disclose; extra aftercare protocol

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Does waxing make hair grow back thicker?

A: No — this is a myth. Shaving leaves a blunt coarse tip that feels thick. Waxing removes from the root and regrowth comes in with a natural tapered tip — finer over time.

Q: How much does it hurt?

A: First-time waxing is a sharp, brief sensation that fades immediately. By the third visit most clients report minimal discomfort. Underarms and bikini are most sensitive; legs and arms are typically very low discomfort.

Q: Can I wax while pregnant?

A: Yes — waxing is generally safe during pregnancy. Skin may be more sensitive, especially in the second and third trimester. Always inform your esthetician.

Q: How long until I'm fully smooth after my first appointment?

A: Immediately smooth, but scattered stubble may appear within 1–2 weeks as hairs in earlier growth phases catch up. By the second or third appointment, regrowth evens out as cycles sync.

Q: Can I wax over a tattoo?

A: Yes — as long as the tattoo is fully healed (minimum 4–6 weeks). Fresh or healing tattoos must not be waxed; wax can pull ink and damage the design permanently.

Q: What if I get dark spots after waxing?

A: Post-inflammatory hyperpigmentation is most common in Fitzpatrick skin types IV–VI and coarse hair zones. Treat with niacinamide, vitamin C, or azelaic acid and protect from UV.

Q: When should I book before a vacation?

A: 3–5 days before your trip, not the night before. Skin needs to fully settle before sun, salt water, and chlorine exposure. Never wax the same day as the beach.



HOUSE OF ROSE AESTHETICS

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